

# MARKDOWN FORMATTING GUIDE — authoring for the DOCX renderer

## Working document

|           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Corpus    | 02_STAC_8_203_38                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Source    | markdown_formatting_guide.md                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Integrity | sha256 43bd43177a7b · rendered 2026-07-09                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Status    | <i>Derived render for review. The markdown source file governs; the modernized layer is never quotable; all readings are provisional pending the commissioned professional transcription (names above all). Canonical apparatus: <code>_PRECISION_PASS_LEDGER.md</code>; method: <code>TRANSCRIPTION_AND_ANALYSIS_METHODODOLOGY.md</code>.</i> |

## How to read this render (conventions legend)

|                                                                           |                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <del>strikethrough</del>                                                  | struck in the manuscript (source: <code>~~text~~</code> )                                                                           |
| superscript                                                               | scribal interlineation or raised letters (source: <code>^text^</code> , <code>m^r</code> )                                          |
| shaded serif span                                                         | diplomatic text quoted inline (source: <code>`text`</code> ); conventions inside are rendered too                                   |
| boxed serif panel                                                         | diplomatic transcription block                                                                                                      |
| gray italic <code>[[...]]</code>                                          | pass-annotation — editorial apparatus, NOT manuscript text                                                                          |
| <div>CONFIRM</div> <div>UPGRADE</div> <div>LEAN</div> <div>CONFLICT</div> | delta-log verdict class: green = confirmed/convergent · blue = upgraded/new · amber = lean/open/variant · red = retraction/conflict |
| <code>[?] / [...] / [ ] · « » ·    · △ ✓ eB X</code><br>★                 | sigla printed verbatim per methodology §6/§9                                                                                        |

## Contents

|                                                                                                |   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| 1. INLINE CONVENTIONS (work everywhere: paragraphs, tables, panels, cells).....                | 2 |
| 2. MODE B — THE WORKING-FILE RECOGNIZER (existing <code>`_WORKING_*`</code> conventions) ..... | 3 |
| 2.1 Headings → banners .....                                                                   | 3 |
| 2.2 Census-line bullets → three-column Lines table .....                                       | 3 |
| 2.3 Band records → two-column table .....                                                      | 4 |
| 2.4 Blockquotes — three renders by content .....                                               | 4 |
| 2.5 Stitched composites → anchor/text table .....                                              | 4 |
| 2.6 Census summaries → shaded box.....                                                         | 4 |
| 2.7 Delta logs → chip-classified entries.....                                                  | 4 |
| 2.8 Markdown tables .....                                                                      | 5 |

|                                                                       |   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| 3. MODE A — THE EXPLICIT MS-TAG FORMAT (new reviewer documents) ..... | 5 |
| 4. WHAT THE RENDERER ADDS AUTOMATICALLY (do not author these) .....   | 6 |
| 5. AUTHORIZING CHECKLIST (run before rendering anything new).....     | 6 |

**Scope:** every working/reviewer markdown file in this corpus directory. **Renderer:** `../_working_docx_renderer.py` (shared across manuscript corpora: STAC\_8\_203\_38, HLS\_MS149\_Floyd\_ff81r-83v). **Output:** `docx_exports/<name>.docx`, with a legend page and a source-sha256 footer.

```
python3 ../_working_docx_renderer.py <file.md> [more.md ...] [-o OUTDIR]
python3 ../_working_docx_renderer.py <corpus_dir>          # batch: renders the whole
# reviewer set (_WORKING_*.md, READING_COMPANION*, ledger, concordance,
# corrections log, READMEs, hand atlases, this guide)
python3 ../_working_docx_renderer.py --pdf <corpus_dir> [...]  # + silent PDF
# into docx_exports/pdfs/. Word takes NO focus and shows NO window
# (launch + hidden document, per the kirchner_tools pattern); your own
# open Word documents are untouched.

# THE STANDING WORKFLOW: after ANY formatter change, reconvert everything -
python3 ../_working_docx_renderer.py --pdf "01_HLS_MS149_Floyd_ff81r-83v"
"02_STAC_8_203_38"
```

### Governing rules (before any formatting question):

- 1. The markdown source governs.** The DOCX is a derived render; never edit content in Word and never treat a render as authority. The footer's sha256 pins each render to the exact source state — a stale render is detectable, not dangerous.
- 2. Never rewrite the evidence layer to please the renderer.** Existing `_WORKING_*` files are the transcription record; the renderer adapts to THEM (Mode B below). New reviewer-facing documents may be authored in the explicit tag format (Mode A).
- 3. The diplomatic conventions are semantics, not style** (methodology §6, §9). The renderer's job is to make them *visible* (real strikethrough, real superscript) without ever *altering* them.

## 1. INLINE CONVENTIONS (work everywhere: paragraphs, tables, panels, cells)

| You write                                                        | Renders as                     | Meaning                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <code>text</code>                                                | <del>strikethrough</del>       | struck in the manuscript (scribal deletion) |
| <code>word</code>                                                | <sup>superscript</sup>         | scribal interlineation                      |
| <code>m<sup>r</sup>, vj<sup>te</sup>, Ex[?]<sup>[2]</sup></code> | <sup>superscript cluster</sup> | raised letters / superscript abbreviation   |

| You write                                       | Renders as                    | Meaning                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>text</code>                               | superscript <b>and</b> struck | struck interlineation (revision stack)                                                                                |
| <code>text</code>                               | shaded Cambria span           | diplomatic text quoted inline — <b>conventions inside the backticks are rendered too</b> (Edwardes = shaded + struck) |
| <code>[[4B: note]]</code>                       | gray italic, brackets kept    | pass-annotation — editorial apparatus, NOT manuscript text                                                            |
| <b>bold</b> , <i>italic</i>                     | bold / italic                 | emphasis (apparatus voice)                                                                                            |
| <code>[?] [...] [ ] « » &lt;x&gt;      Λ</code> | verbatim                      | uncertain / supplied / illegible / insertion / expansion / cuts & seams / caret — printed as-is, they ARE the record  |
| <code>△ △ △ ✓ ✓ ✓ ✓ eB X ★ ● ○ □</code>         | verbatim                      | status codes per methodology §9                                                                                       |

**Caret disambiguation (only subtle rule in the grammar):** a caret directly after a word/bracket character opens a SHORT raised cluster (`mr` → superscript r); a caret after a space/start opens a PAIRED interlineation and needs its closer (`said`). If an interlineation follows a word with no space, put a space before the caret. Paired interlineations must close within ~90 characters — longer insertions belong in a `[[...]]` note or their own line.

**Escaping:** there is none. If you need a literal `~` or `^` (almost never — the legend documents syntax by example), rephrase or wrap in a `[[...]]` note.

## 2. MODE B — THE WORKING-FILE RECOGNIZER (existing ``_WORKING_*` conventions)

The renderer detects these exact shapes. Keep new working files inside them and the render is automatic.

### 2.1 Headings → banners

```
# FILE TITLE          -> dark title banner (page 1; first # only)
## LEFT HALF-COLUMN (x 0.05-0.55) -> full-width DARK section banner
## Band 3 (src y 1062-1698) - ... -> LIGHT sub-banner ("Band N" prefix triggers it)
### / ####           -> ordinary bold headings
---                  -> horizontal rule
```

### 2.2 Census-line bullets → three-column Lines table

```
- L12: `w[i]th him a greate[?] |` - note text here
- c3: `R[?]u[?]l[...] |`
- b7: `[?]o[?]nte[?] of the bill ...`
```

Shape: - LABEL: \diplomatic\ — apparatus-note. Labels matching c/L/b/R + number (+letter) (e.g. L12, c3, L1b, L8–L9) become the bold anchor column; the backticked text becomes the Cambria column; anything after — becomes the gray apparatus column. Consecutive census bullets merge into ONE table —

a caption line immediately above (e.g. **CAPTION BLOCK (...)** / **DEPOSITION LINES (...)**) becomes the table caption.

**Generic form (any corpus's label convention):** - **LABEL:** \diplomatic\ — note — ANY bold label up to ~64 chars ending in a colon, immediately followed by a backticked span, is a census row; the label prints verbatim (qualifiers included). This is how the HLS folio.line labels work: - **81r.6 L (¶ opener, big swash majuscule):** \<T/S>he <plt> ... \ — THREE questions.... The label column widens automatically for long labels. Bold-opener bullets WITHOUT a following backtick span stay ordinary bullets (safe for **eB queue after L b1-2:** ... and similar).

## 2.3 Band records → two-column table

```
- **b1 (caption):** `xam[inati]o capt~...` · `[An]no regni ...`
```

- **bN ...:** tokens rows merge into a band table (anchor | tokens).

## 2.4 Blockquotes — three renders by content

```
> **ffrom. / W[ho]e gave you Instruciones ...**      -> boxed diplomatic PANEL
>                                                    (warm off-white, Cambria)
> ★ (1) commentary sentence ...                    -> indented apparatus commentary
> [[PHASE 4B FOLD-IN ...]] ...                      -> bordered gray note panel
```

Blank > lines split panels. Inside one panel, a new line starting with *(margin ...)*, **N**, a digit+./:, or ★ begins a new visual paragraph.

## 2.5 Stitched composites → anchor/text table

```
> **L1** John Towneley of [C]raue[n?] ... · **L1b** (right half only) ... ·
> **L2** To the 3[d?] Interr[ogatorie] ...
```

The chain separator · immediately before **Ln** splits rows; each **anchor** gets its own left cell. The manuscript's own / virgules are untouched.

## 2.6 Census summaries → shaded box

Any paragraph beginning **Census:** renders as a shaded summary box.

## 2.7 Delta logs → chip-classified entries

```
1. **CONFIRM (eyes-on, independent):** body ...
2. **UPGRADE — baseline `[bringing]` (supplied) → eyes-read** `bring[in]g[e][?]' ...
10. **RETRACTIONS (my own in-pass leads):** ...
```

Numbered items whose bold text OPENS with a verdict word get a colored chip:

| Chip color | Verdict words           |
|------------|-------------------------|
| green      | CONFIRM, CONVERGENCE    |
| blue       | UPGRADE, NEW, STRUCTURE |
| amber      | LEAN, OPEN, VARIANT     |

| Chip color | Verdict words           |
|------------|-------------------------|
| red        | RETRACTION(S), CONFLICT |

Use these words as the FIRST word of the bold opener; anything else renders as a plain numbered entry (no chip — fine for non-verdict lists).

## 2.8 Markdown tables

Standard `| a | b |` tables render with shaded header row and full conventions inside cells.

## 3. MODE A — THE EXPLICIT MS-TAG FORMAT (new reviewer documents)

For newly authored documents (reviewer summaries, crux sheets, collation reports), write the structure explicitly — same grammar family as the DDC exhibit format. Tags sit alone on their line.

```
[TITLE: MEMBRANE 009 — REVIEWER CRUX SHEET]

[META]
Corpus: TNA STAC 8/203/38 (record copy RC8368179)
Leaf: membrane 009 (Articles 13-16)
Status: readings provisional pending professional transcription
[/META]

[SECTION: THE STRUCK REWARD QUESTION]

[DIPLOMATIC]
~~[Did they give?] anie r[e]ward, [tendred?] or [pro]mised [__] [to/by?]
the ^said^ M[r] Barker [__] / and[?] what was the[?] cause the[re]of[?]?~~
[/DIPLOMATIC]

[COMMENT]
Two cramped lines squeezed between L8 and the Art-14 opener — an
afterthought insertion, then struck entire. [[multispectral target]]
[/COMMENT]

[HEADER: WHAT THE REVIEWER SHOULD CHECK]

[LINES: Art-13 zone, membrane 009]
L8 | `name him or them that did soe doe.` | precedes the struck zone
L8a | `~anie r[e]ward [tendred?] or [pro]mised~` | the struck insertion
[/LINES]

[CENSUS]
31 lines + rotated 4-line endorsement; foot otherwise blank; unsigned.
[/CENSUS]

[DELTA: 3 | OPEN]
The party-styling cluster "Adfe[c/r]t" leads "ad sect[am] Barker" — not
asserted anywhere; USER + TNA arbitration first.
```

```
[FOOTNOTE: Tiles: crops/stac_p4b/_manifest.jsonl; ledger item D12.]
```

```
[END]
```

| Tag                            | Renders as                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| [TITLE: ...]                   | cover title (also drives the banner if no # heading)                                          |
| [META] key: value ... [/META]  | boxed two-column metadata table                                                               |
| [SECTION: NAME] ... [/SECTION] | dark banner; closing tag draws a rule                                                         |
| [HEADER: NAME]                 | light sub-banner                                                                              |
| [LINES: caption] rows [/LINES] | Lines table; each row LABEL   text   note (text column may use backticks; conventions render) |
| [DIPLOMATIC] ... [/DIPLOMATIC] | boxed diplomatic panel (Cambria)                                                              |
| [COMMENT] ... [/COMMENT]       | indented apparatus commentary                                                                 |
| [CENSUS] ... [/CENSUS]         | shaded census box                                                                             |
| [DELTA: n   VERDICT] body      | numbered entry with verdict chip (vocabulary in §2.7)                                         |
| [FOOTNOTE: ...]                | gray apparatus note                                                                           |
| [END]                          | stop rendering (anything after is ignored)                                                    |

Both modes may be mixed in one file; the tag form wins wherever it appears.

#### 4. WHAT THE RENDERER ADDS AUTOMATICALLY (do not author these)

- **Title block:** dark banner from the first #/[TITLE:], document-class subtitle (inferred from the filename: LINE\_INDEX / TRANSCRIPTION / LEDGER / COMPANION), Source/Integrity/Status metadata box, and the provisionality rubric.
- **Conventions legend** with live exemplars (real strike, real superscript, real chips).
- **Contents inventory** (documents with ≥ 6 sections): a compact section/band list after the legend. No page numbers by design — banners are real Heading-styled paragraphs, so **Word's navigation pane (View → Sidebar → Navigation) gives live jumps**; the printed list is the inventory for PDF readers.
- **Pagination hygiene:** banners never split across pages and stay with their content; table rows never split mid-row; multi-page Lines tables repeat their header row.
- **Monochrome sigla:**  is pinned to a symbol font in amber ink so it renders as a scholarly glyph, never a color emoji — author it as the plain  character and let the renderer handle presentation.
- **Footer on every page:** <source>.md · sha256 <12 hex> · p. N of M. After editing a source file, re-run the renderer; a reviewer can always detect a stale render by hashing the .md.

#### 5. AUTHORING CHECKLIST (run before rendering anything new)

- [ ] Diplomatic text is inside backticks (inline) or panels/Lines rows — never bare in apparatus prose.
- [ ] Every , ,  pairs off (grep-count the delimiters; odd counts = a leak).

- [ ] Census bullets follow - LABEL: \text\ — note exactly (colon after label, backticks, spaced em-dash).
- [ ] Delta verdicts use the §2.7 vocabulary as the first bold word.
- [ ] Modernized-layer text is clearly labeled and never inside backticks or [DIPLOMATIC] (it must not look quotable).
- [ ] Render, open the DOCX, and check the ONE thing machines miss: that nothing which is *your* voice ended up styled as *manuscript* voice (Cambria/panel/shaded), or vice versa. Voice confusion is the only render error that can mislead a reviewer.

*Cross-references: conventions & status codes — ../TRANSCRIPTION\_AND\_ANALYSIS\_METHODOLOGY.md §6, §9; renderer source (rendering contract in its docstring) — ../\_working\_docx\_render.py; reviewer package — README\_FOR\_REVIEWERS.md.*